

to VMware Workstation in terms of features and has some extra benefits. We'll discuss about VirtualBox as well, later.

Creating a new Virtual Machine (VM)

Creating a new virtual machine in VMware Workstation is no big deal and is intuitive. We'll show you how. But before we proceed, note that we used openSUSE 12.1 with Gnome 3 and VMware Workstation version 8.0.1 for the guide here. Depending on your OS, the menu options would differ a bit and you may have a slightly different organization of buttons on the screen, but that won't be difficult to figure out at all!

To create a new virtual machine in VMware Workstation, follow the steps: Go to File menu and click "New Virtual Machine".

On the new window that opens, you have two options to configure your virtual machine for the start:

- ▶ **Typical (recommended):** This method, as it says is recommended. It keeps it easy on you if you're new to the virtualization scene.

- ▶ **Custom (advanced):**

This method, once again, as it says is for the advanced user (or a brave one who's ready for experiments, right away). You get to define a whole lot of hardware interfaces and methodologies that VMware Workstation will use



Figure 5: Menu option to create a new virtual machine

and define the machine's compatibility with other VMware products. Since it's unlikely that an average user would have the advanced tools from VMware to bother about compatibility, we wouldn't suggest this option if you don't fully understand what you're doing. Committing mistakes over here would affect the performance or stability of the guest OS you're going to use. However, you need not worry too much, for all you're going to create is a virtual machine and you can delete it anytime you want, if experimentation is all you want to do. If you're an advanced user and are going to use the virtual machine to seriously learn virtualization, you probably already know the intricacies, and if you're a new user who's ready for experiments and you don't want to use